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Grade	1	Word Count	208
Lexile	460L	Multi-level	N/A
Learning A–Z	level H		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

Explore the amazing art of sand sculpting in **Statues in the Sand**. Follow along with sand sculptors as they create animals, famous figures, and even cities completely out of sand. Students will enjoy the detailed photographs and simple text about these extraordinary pieces of art.

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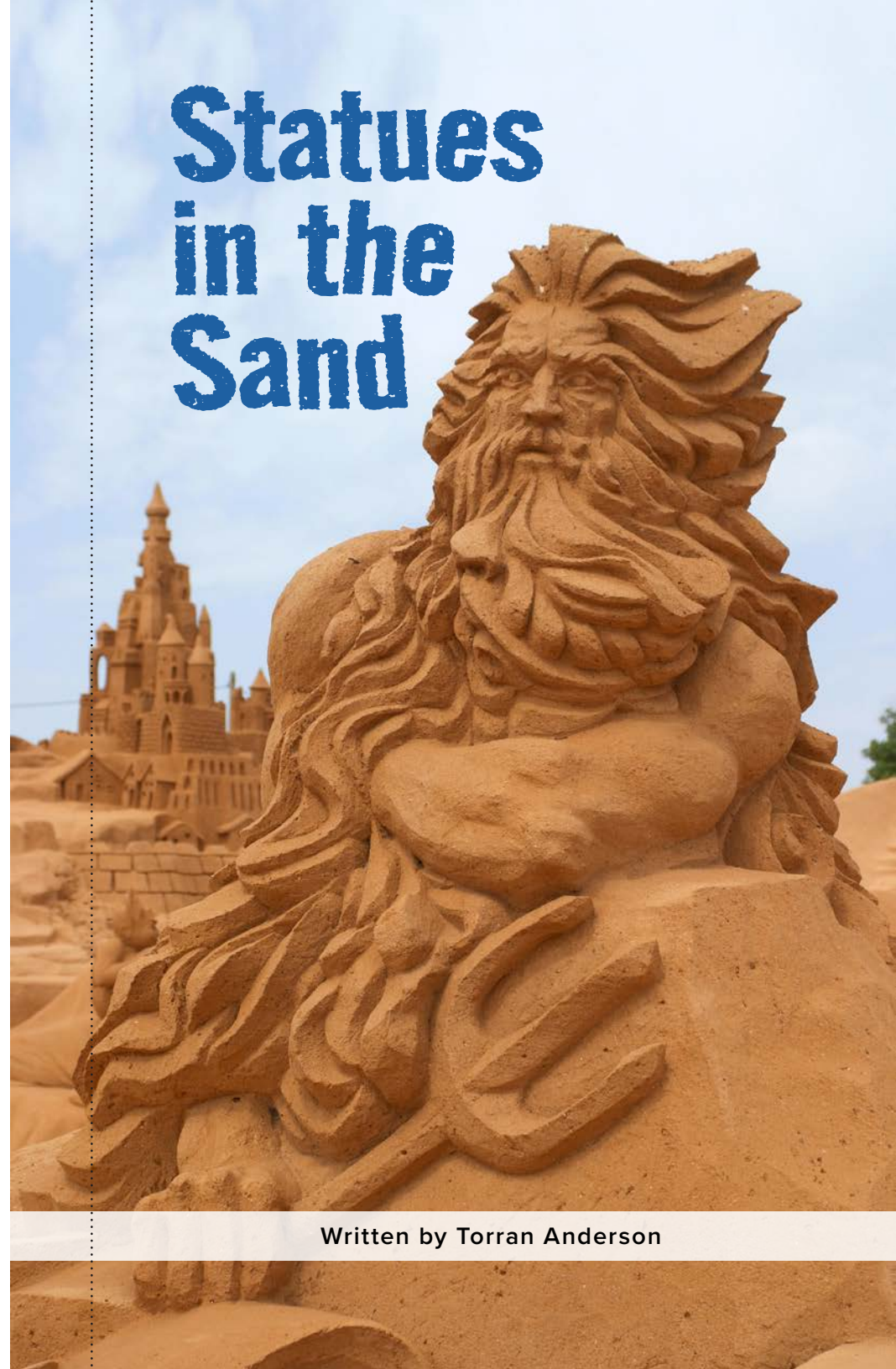
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Statues in the Sand



Written by Torran Anderson

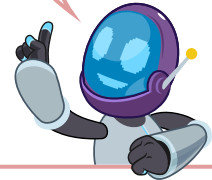
Statues in the Sand



Written by Torran Anderson

Focus Question

How can sand sculpting be considered a form of art?



Words to Know

amazing

carve

contests

sand castles

sculptors

statues



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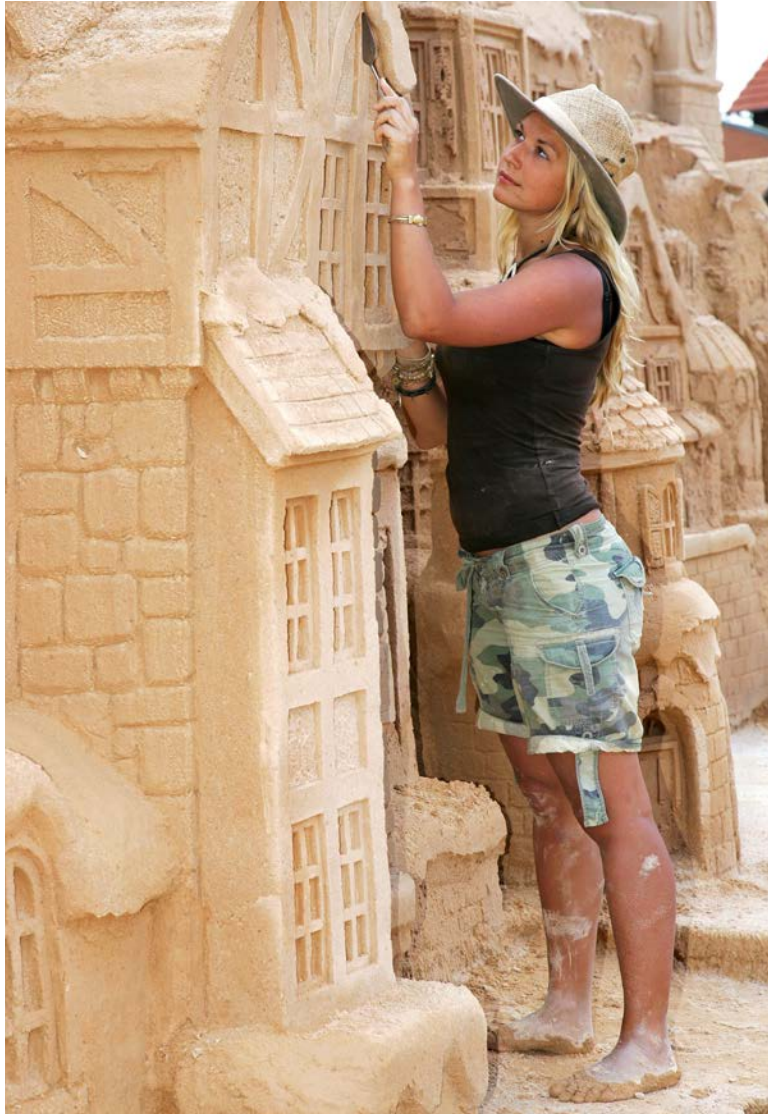
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Introduction

You may have seen **sand castles** at the beach.

Have you ever seen one like this?



Some people get paid to play
in the sand.
They are called sand **sculptors**.



Sand Sculptors

Sand sculptors don't just make
amazing sand castles.
They are artists who use sand
to make interesting **statues**.



Do You Know?

Sand sculptors often spray their finished statues with glue. The glue keeps the sand statues from falling down.

Some of their sand statues take days to make.
The sand statues can last for months.

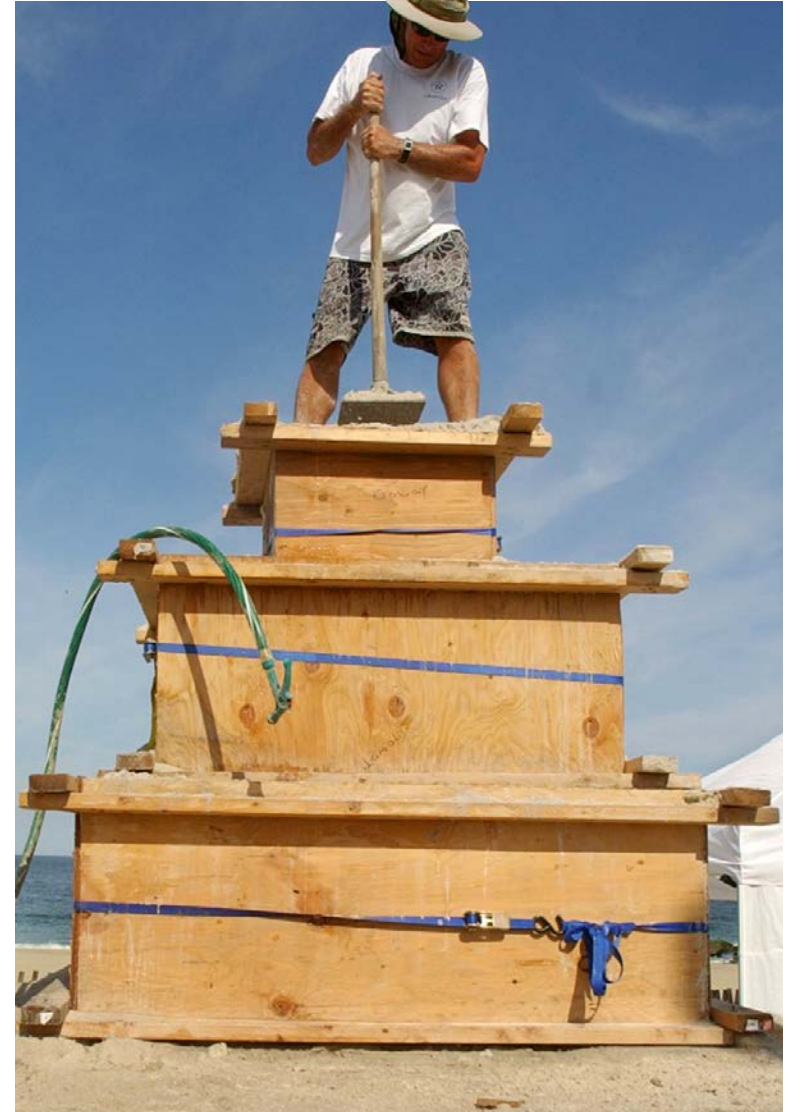


What Sand Sculptors Do

It takes a lot of work to make giant sand statues.
First, sand sculptors need a big pile of sand.



Then they fill wooden walls
with sand.
They wet the sand as they
fill the walls.



Next, they jump on the wet sand
to pack it down.
This is called a *pound-up*.



Finally, the sculptors begin to **carve** the sand.

They start carving from the top of their sandpile.

Sand sculptors use tools and their hands to carve the sand.



Amazing Sand Statues

Sand sculptors can carve sand to look like real people.



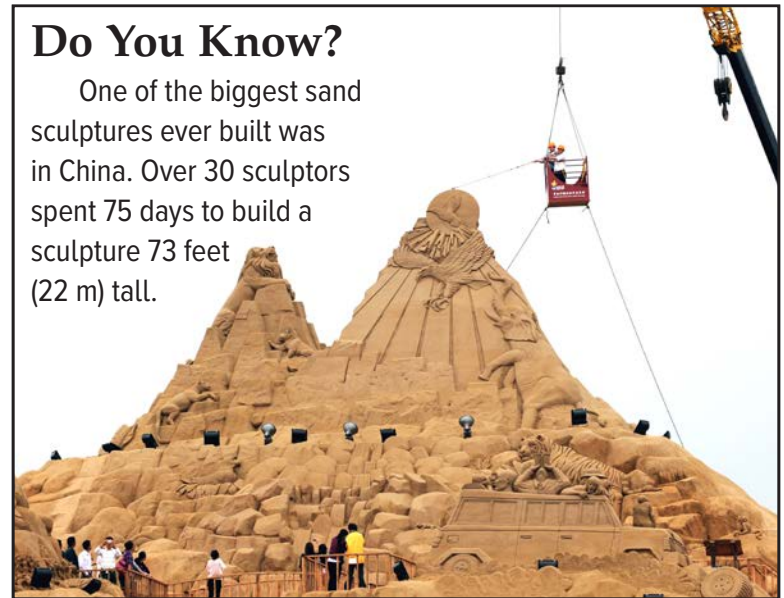
They can make animals that have teeth and claws.



Sand sculptors can even shape the sand to look like a city.
Sand sculptors go to **contests** around the world.

Do You Know?

One of the biggest sand sculptures ever built was in China. Over 30 sculptors spent 75 days to build a sculpture 73 feet (22 m) tall.





Conclusion

Sand sculptors make all kinds of amazing statues out of sand. They all started the same way, though. They started by playing in the sand.

Glossary

amazing (*adj.*) page 6
causing great wonder or surprise

carve (*v.*) page 11
to make something, such as a sculpture, by carefully cutting and shaping a material

contests (*n.*) page 14
events where people do something for the purpose of winning

sand castles (*n.*) page 4
small sculptures of castles or other buildings made of wet sand

sculptors (*n.*) page 5
artists who shape wood, clay, stone, metal, or other materials

statues (*n.*) page 6
works of art made of wood, stone, or other materials, usually in the shape of a person or other animal